

Form Elements: Radio, Checkbox, Select & Textarea

HTML forms • Choosing options • Dropdowns • Multiline input

1. Radio Buttons

Use **radio buttons** when users need to select **only one option** from a group. Radio buttons in the same group should use the same **name** attribute.

```
<p>Choose your gender:</p>

<input type="radio" id="male" name="gender" value="male">
<label for="male">Male</label><br>

<input type="radio" id="female" name="gender" value="female">
<label for="female">Female</label>
```

2. Checkboxes

Use **checkboxes** when users can select **multiple options**. Each checkbox represents an independent choice.

```
<p>Select your hobbies:</p>

<input type="checkbox" id="reading" name="hobby" value="reading">
<label for="reading">Reading</label><br>

<input type="checkbox" id="sports" name="hobby" value="sports">
<label for="sports">Sports</label><br>

<input type="checkbox" id="music" name="hobby" value="music">
<label for="music">Music</label>
```

3. Dropdown List — Select Menu

Use the **<select>** element with **<option>** elements to let users choose an option from a dropdown.

```
<label for="city">Choose a city:</label>

<select id="city" name="city">
  <option value="delhi">Delhi</option>
  <option value="mumbai">Mumbai</option>
  <option value="bangalore">Bangalore</option>
</select>
```

4. Textarea — Multiline Input

Use the **<textarea>** element when users need to type **multiple lines of text**, such as comments or messages.

```
<label for="message">Your Message:</label><br>

<textarea id="message" name="message"
  rows="4" cols="30"></textarea>
```

Quick Reference

Element	Purpose	Selection / Input
<input type="radio">	Choose from a group	One option
<input type="checkbox">	Choose independent options	Multiple options
<select>	Display a dropdown	One option by default

Element	Purpose	Selection / Input
<textarea>	Enter longer text	Multiple lines

TIP

- Use radio buttons for single-choice questions.
- Use checkboxes for multiple selections.
- Use select for compact dropdowns.
- Use textarea for longer input such as comments or messages.

Quick Takeaway

Radio = one choice • **Checkbox** = multiple choices • **Select** = compact dropdown • **Textarea** = multiple lines